Architectural Models For a Tiny Home

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Conceptual Model



- **Use:** Shows the basic shape, size, and design of the tiny home.
- **Cost:** $5–$10
- **Knowledge:** Beginner level; basic measuring and cutting skills.
- **Technology:** Ruler, pencil, scissors, and craft knife.
- **Materials:** Cardboard, foam board, and glue.
- **Time:** 2–3 hours.
- **Steps to complete:**
- Sketch the tiny home.
- Choose a scale.
- Cut simple geometric shapes.
- Assemble the walls and roof.
- Glue the model onto a base.

Cardboard Model



- **Use:** Shows the exterior of the tiny home, including walls, doors, windows, and roof.
- **Cost:** $3–$10
- **Knowledge:** Beginner level.
- **Technology:** Basic hand tools and measuring equipment.
- **Materials:** Recycled cardboard, ruler, glue, scissors, and paint.
- **Time:** 3–5 hours.
- **Steps to complete:**
- Draw the walls and roof.
- Measure and cut the cardboard.
- Cut openings for doors and windows.
- Glue the walls together.
- Attach the roof and add details.

Interior Cutaway Model



- **Use:** Shows the inside of the tiny home and how the rooms are arranged.
- **Cost:** $5–$15
- **Knowledge:** Beginner to intermediate level; basic understanding of floor plans.
- **Technology:** Ruler, craft knife, and a floor plan.
- **Materials:** Foam board, cardboard, glue, colored paper, and miniature furniture.
- **Time:** 4–6 hours.
- **Steps to complete:**
- Draw the floor plan.
- Cut the floor and walls.
- Leave one side open or make the roof removable.
- Add the kitchen, bathroom, bed, and living area.
- Label the different spaces.

Foam Board Model

- **Use:** Creates a clean and accurate model for presenting the tiny-home design.
- **Cost:** $8–$20
- **Knowledge:** Beginner to intermediate level; accurate measuring and cutting skills.
- **Technology:** Ruler, cutting mat, craft knife, and optional computer drawings.
- **Materials:** Foam board, glue, clear plastic for windows, and paint.
- **Time:** 4–8 hours.
- **Steps to complete:**
- Draw scaled templates for the walls and floor.
- Cut the foam board carefully.
- Create openings for doors and windows.
- Assemble the walls and floor.
- Add the roof and finishing details.

Digital 3D Model



- **Use:** Creates a digital version of the tiny home before building a physical model.
- **Cost:** $0–$20 for a basic student project using free software.
- **Knowledge:** Beginner to intermediate level; basic computer and 3D modeling skills.
- **Technology:** Computer and software such as SketchUp Free.
- **Materials:** No physical materials are required.
- **Time:** 3–6 hours.
- **Steps to complete:**
- Draw the floor plan digitally.
- Create the walls and floor.
- Add doors and windows.
- Build the roof.
- Apply colors and materials.
- Save images of the finished model.